



Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Walter's comments in Dropbox

7 messages

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 3:42 PM

To: wdemelle@gmail.com, Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

I can see that Walter is commenting on some of the photos within Dropbox.

It's much easier for me to reply to an email rather than reply to comments in Dropbox, so please could you summarise any further queries and send them to me in an email. I'll reply to the current queries below.

It's also quite time consuming to answer queries, so would Todd please indicate that he's happy for me to charge my time to do so.

Meanwhile, Walter you can ignore [P1070510.JPG](#) and the other photos in this particular folder - I had told Todd I would access this file to see whether it mentioned the land grant, it doesn't, but I took a few pictures of the index to show what the file contained

You comment elsewhere re the name Levell Demell; as per my previous email to Todd, the spelling of the name varies from list to list

"Leven Demell", 'Luen Demi', 'Lewin Demel', 'Leven Demell', 'Lew. Demel',.. The spelling finally settles down to 'Leven Demell'"

NB **Levell** Demell is not a variant shown.

I don't have a problem with these Variant spellings - assuming you are sure that 'Levi Demell' was in the 60th foot, the individual I have identified is the only candidate.

You say you can't read the script on some of the images - I'm afraid that transcribing them would take a great deal of time and I won't attempt to do so unless Todd gives me a budget for it.. Again, in my email to him (which I had assumed he had shared with you) I explained that in the final playlist where I found Leven, and when the 7th Bn was disbanded:

"Here Leven is annotated with a check mark with 2 lines through it; Notes on the playlist say that 'men checked out thus ..are charged sub[sequentl]y in 3d B[atallio]n 60th per Return voucher 6 of P[ay] L[ist] to Sep 17 of that Bn'."

I hope this answers your questions.

I look forward to hearing from Todd as to what, if anything, he wishes me to do next and how much time he's prepared to invest. Until then I'll hold off on any further replies.

Best regards

Ruth

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 3:46 PM

To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Hi Todd

I hope you're OK with my email to your uncle. I know from bitter experience that trying to answer loads of questions from multiple sources can be very time consuming, and I normally prefer only to deal with the actual client. In this case I was happy to answer the questions your uncle had, but would prefer not to make this a continuing process.

I hope you understand.

Best regards

Ruth

[Quoted text hidden]

Walter DeMelle <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 4:12 PM

To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Let's digest this one step at a time. No need to have her do anything unnecessary. I think that it is fair to say Leven Demell is our man. I have seen so many variations of handwriting that it is clear to me this is likely our guy.

I am certain (in my memory) that I came across pretty strong evidence of a land grant. I am hoping I will find those notes somewhere when I start really digging into the file cabinet in my office. What would be helpful if she could find enlistment papers for LD. Some indication of where he was prior to the military service.

Anyway. Good job. I cannot for some reason open the copy of her bill which you paid. Can you send it to me as a PDF?

This afternoon I am trying to process the terribly sad news that Jenni sent about Rob and Tina. Heartbreaking.

Walter DeMelle
POB 1453
Lakeville, CT 06039

Begin forwarded message:

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Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 4:35 PM

Thank you, Ruth. My impression is you are an experienced professional with our best interest in mind and I appreciate your candor. Thank you for watching over the cost and checking in with me before undertaking anything overly costly and time consuming! There is certainly a limit to my resources, but I'm willing to invest in the reasonable pursuit of what might be priceless information about our family history and would feel fortunate to do so in league with my Uncle Skip, my name for Walter since I was a boy. I hope between the three of us, we can define what that balance is as we proceed. I'm happy to pay for your time answering general questions from Walter and me as we hash things out in the course of discussion in email and hope you will continue to let me/us know your thoughts on cost/value regarding research, transcription and other more time consuming undertakings. I feel that we are living in a time where we have a receding opportunity to define the edge of recorded history and would love to shore up what crumbling pieces of my family line we can find while we still can and keep them from the abyss!

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Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 5:06 PM

Thank you Todd.

I'll be sure to keep both you and Walter in the loop, and will endeavour to be as explicit as I can about what I find and how to interpret the records.

I'll report back on Tuesday after I've re-examined the playlists, and searched the PoW registers.

Best regards
Ruth

[Quoted text hidden]

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Walter DeMelle <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 5:23 PM

Hi Skip,

Oh no! Last I heard Rob was back home and doing a bit better. Has something happened today?

Regarding the genealogy stuff, no worries! I don't mind paying Ruth for consulting with you and me in email regarding what our possible courses might be. (Her fee is £25/hr. I've paid for two hours.) I don't expect it will take too long to identify what the possibilities are. Then we can decide which, if any, it's worth investing in following. I'll forward over the emails she's sent me so far. I thought they were in the history of the mail I cced you on!

I expect the next round of research she'll be doing to shake out any hidden clues there may be in the documents we're familiar with and give her a chance to use her experience to take what we've found and parlay it into another line of inquiry that, hopefully, finds the family's origins in Europe.

From the hardcopy of notes that has been sitting on my bookshelf for years that I believe you gave me, I assume you came across Levi's military records in Nova Scotia somewhere on microfilm. (I wonder if there's more to be found there? Is Nova Scotia where you found the microfilm?) I see those as establishing the unit he served in and creating a definitive link to the records Ruth has found. I agree. Leven Demell is our guy!

Re: the landgrant, we have this from Allen Robertson's investigation...

RG 20 "A": Post-1800 [Land Grant Papers]: DeMill, Levi ---see: Ross, William (Lieut.) & Others 1822

---Ross, William (Lieut.) & Others 1822: Draft Grant: to military settlers at Sherbrooke Settlement, 6900 acres of land in Lunenburg and Kings Counties. [Includes several German names: ... eg. Kiens, Graff, Clotiz, Shipain, Hession]: Levi DeMill-- 200 acres.

(I wonder if there is some connection between Sherbrooke Fort in Castine, ME, where elements of Levi's unit were stationed in 1812, and the Settlement.)

From what Ruth found, Leven seems to have volunteered (along with a large number of other men) for the KGL in 1813 while he was a prisoner of war presumably in Halifax. Not a typical enlistment! If that's the case, he could have originated anywhere!

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Walter DeMelle <wdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 6:01 PM

I think I have all the correspondence now so don't bother sending to me. Let's see where she goes. I also will forward an email Jenni sent to us earlier today about Rob's worsening condition. You may be already fully informed. We hadn't heard anything since Tina wrote to say they weren't able after all to come to our party for Brendan and Christine.

Walter DeMelle
POB 1453
Lakeville, CT 06039

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